Ahlam Zahran

AI Engineer & Data Scientist
+962 796 937 348 | zahran.ahlam2002@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/ahlam-zahran | github.com/Ahlam-Zahran | Portfolio
Amman, Jordan | U.S. citizen | Open to relocation (Saudi Arabia, UAE, U.S.)

Summary

AI engineer and data scientist with hands-on experience training, evaluating and deploying computer-vision and generative models. Reimplemented and verified a CVPR 2023 fMRI-to-image pipeline, reaching **82.1%** identification accuracy (chance 50%, $p = 0.001$) and shipped it as a full-stack web application. Strong in statistical rigour and end-to-end delivery.

Education

University of Petra — Amman, Jordan
B.Sc. in Artificial Intelligence & Data Science | GPA: 3.59/4.00 — *Feb 2022 – Jul 2026*

German Jordanian University — Amman, Jordan
Biomedical Engineering (transferred) — *Sep 2019 – Jun 2022*

Experience

Neurender (research project) — Amman, Jordan
Founder & Lead Researcher — *2026 – Present*

- Leading independent research continuing NeuroSeekers: AI that reconstructs the image a person is seeing from fMRI brain scans, with every result scored, bounded and traceable.
- Extending decoding to new people without retraining (cross-person decoding), working toward validation on standard 3-Tesla hospital scanners and a public verification standard for brain-decoding claims.

NeuroSeekers — University of Petra
AI Engineer & Full-Stack Developer (graduation project) — *2025 – 2026*

- Reimplemented and verified the Takagi & Nishimoto (CVPR 2023) fMRI-to-image pipeline on one subject, reaching **82.1%** two-way identification accuracy on 982 held-out images (chance 50%; $p = 0.001$, no one of 1,000 shuffled controls reached it).
- Trained subject-specific decoders on the Natural Scenes Dataset (7T fMRI, 26,688 voxels per image): ROI-wise encoding, ridge regression and latent-space decoding; Stable Diffusion image generation with a blind candidate selector.
- Built the evaluation framework: test-retest reliability, null tests, 16 pre-registered variants and a provenance record for every result.
- Shipped a full-stack web app (Django, React) with a live demo and real-time analysis, ∼30 seconds per reconstruction run.
- Presented at **SOFEX Jordan 2025** (under the patronage of HRH Crown Prince Al Hussein bin Abdullah II) and **SOFEX Aqaba 2026**; covered by Jordan TV, Roya TV, AlMamlaka TV, Amen FM and The Jordan Times.

Bait Misk | The Concept Coffee Store — Jordan
Supply Chain Manager — *Apr 2026 – Jun 2026*

- Built a cost-management system from scratch (13+ suppliers, 56+ ingredient unit costs, per-item menu costing) and tracked thousands of SKUs with Excel and Power BI dashboards.

IEEE Computational Intelligence Society — University of Petra
Student Chapter Chair — *2024*

- Led technical events, workshops and outreach; also taught hands-on Arduino IoT workshops (2024).

Projects & Awards

Autonomous Humanitarian Demining Robot — 2026
2nd Place, World Robot Caspian Cup (WRCC), Open Category, Baku

- Autonomous robot combining computer vision, LiDAR, GPS, ROS2 and sensor fusion for safer mine detection.

Peer-to-Peer Energy Trading Platform — 2024
1st Place, WEFE Hackathon

- Reinforcement learning and a greedy algorithm to optimize renewable-energy distribution; full UI/UX prototype in Figma.

AWS DeepRacer — 2023
Top 500 globally

- Designed and trained autonomous racing models with Proximal Policy Optimization (PPO) on AWS SageMaker.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, SQL, Java, JavaScript
AI & ML: PyTorch, TensorFlow, scikit-learn, computer vision, diffusion models (Stable Diffusion), NLP, reinforcement learning, RAG
Data & Neuroimaging: fMRI analysis (NSD), ridge-regression decoding, statistical testing, Power BI, data warehousing
Deployment & Cloud: Django, React, REST APIs, Docker, AWS SageMaker, AWS S3, Git/GitHub
Robotics & IoT: ROS2, Arduino, ESP32, FPGA/VHDL

Certifications & Languages

Certifications: Generative AI with AWS, Udacity (2024); DAAD Business Training, Germany (2024); Erasmus+ RL4Eng, Bonn-Rhein-Sieg University (2023); Multi-Robot Drone Workshop, Sager (2023).
Languages: Arabic (native), English (fluent), German (beginner)